

TAUNTON, ARCHDEACON OF. *See* T. DE ARUNDEL.

THIRNING, WILLIAM.

JUR. C. P. 1388. CM. C. P. 1396.

See under the Reign of Henry IV.

TRESILIAN, ROBERT.

JUR. K. B. 1378. CM. K. B. 1381.

FULLER, in his "Worthies" of Cornwall, says, "there passeth a pleasant Tradition in this County, how there standeth a man of great strength and stature, with a black bill in his hand, at Polstonbridge (the first entrance into Cornwall, as you pass towards Launceston, where the Assizes are holden), ready to knock down all the Lawyers that should offer to plant themselves in that County:" and he adds "in earnest" that few of that profession there have come to any eminence. He omits Robert Tresilian as a native, partly because he is not claimed by Mr. Carew in his Survey¹: but notwithstanding the omission, there can be little doubt that he was a Cornishman. The initial syllable of his surname is presumptive evidence of the fact; but there is better proof in his principal possessions, consisting of several manors and extensive lands there²; and his appearance as an advocate at the assizes of the county in 43 Edward III., 1359³, is not without its weight in fixing his birth-place. He was educated at Oxford, and was elected fellow of Exeter College about the year 1354.

According to the Year Book he does not appear to have had any practice at Westminster till 50 Edward III., 1376, and then to no considerable extent. He appears, however, to have been a king's serjeant in the first year of Richard II.; at the end of which he was constituted a justice of the Court

¹ Fuller's Worthies, i. 212.

² Cal. Inquis. p. m., iiii. 106.

³ Liber Assisarum, 278, 279. In the first of these cases the name is Tre-vilian; and Froissart always calls him so.